HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Things will never get better in this country"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Things will never get better in this country." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What good am I missing?
- ☐ What has improved?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ What can I do locally?
- ☐ Where is my hope?
- ☐ How is despair affecting me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God's purposes stand.
- ☐ I can seek the good of my city.
- ☐ I can pray for those in authority.
- ☐ My citizenship is in heaven.
- ☐ Good is still happening.
- ☐ I can do something locally.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Jeremiah 29:7
  "Seek the prosperity of the city to which I have sent you as exiles. Pray to the LORD on its behalf, for if it prospers, you too will prosper."
- ☐ 1 Timothy 2:1–2
  "First of all, then, I urge that petitions, prayers, intercessions, and thanksgiving be offered for everyone— for kings and all those in authority—so that we may lead tranquil and quiet lives in all godliness and dignity."
- ☐ Philippians 3:20
  "But our citizenship is in heaven, and we eagerly await a Savior from there, the Lord Jesus Christ."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Hope in action: Each week, note one good thing you did or noticed locally.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Jeremiah 29:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will seek the good of my city and pray for it.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Limit the news. Choose a set time and stop.
- ☐ Do one local good. Serve a neighbor or a cause.
- ☐ Pray for leaders. Name them in prayer.
- ☐ Read Jeremiah 29. Notice the instruction to exiles.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Things will never get better in this country": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Hope in action
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Things will never get better in this country.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am discouraged about our country. Anchor my hope in You, teach me to seek the good of my city, and use me where I am. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.